

33. Ask your primary care physician what type of specialist treats the problems you are concerned about to avoid paying for a visit to the wrong type of specialist.
34. Make sure your physician is licensed by checking with state boards.
35. Don't be overly influenced by ads for prescription medicine: Ask about symptoms mentioned in commercials or ads rather than requesting specific medications; stick with your current regimen if it is working without complications. Heavily advertised medications are almost always more expensive than nonpromoted ones.
36. Consider generic drugs to replace name-brand drugs; for a list of generic drugs with their equivalents, check out the Electronic Orange Book (<https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/scripts/cder/ob/index.cfm>).
37. Compare drugs in the same class by price.
38. Cut costs on prescriptions through patient assistance programs; learn more at RxAssist.org or Medicine Assistance Tool (MedicineAssistanceTool.org).
39. Ask for free samples of medication from your physician.
40. Tell your physician about cost concerns and see if there is a less expensive but just as effective alternative treatment.
41. Read the labels and ingredient lists of over-the-counter medicines to make sure that you are not overdosing on certain active ingredients.
42. Say "no" to body scans that are more likely to lead to unnecessary testing and cause harm via radiation rather than detect deadly disease.
43. Take part in group visits with your physician or support groups for those with similar diseases.
44. Exercise, maintain a healthy weight, and don't smoke.
45. Research medical issues using reliable sources such as the MayoClinic.com.
46. Sign up for discount programs with non-insurance companies such as Merck's Patient Assistance Program (available to those who do not have prescription coverage) and Pfizer's program.
47. Visit a dental clinic associated with a dental or dental hygiene training program to save on fees.
48. Tap into hospital programs that offer aid for low-income, low-resource patients.